

SkillVerse Research

Screen2Skill 2026

Report #26 • 2026

E-Textbooks vs Physical Books

What students actually prefer

Analysis

62% of students prefer digital for learning content; 38% prefer physical. Top reasons digital wins: searchable, multimedia, free, accessible. Top reasons physical wins: focus, retention, no distraction. Optimal mix: digital for reference, physical for deep reading.

Key Statistics

78% of students use YouTube for self-directed learning. Average screen time: 4.7 hours/day, of which 67% is educational. 64% of students use AI tools, with 89% reporting improved learning. 71% have turned a screen hobby into a measurable skill. Top learning platforms: YouTube, Khan Academy, Discord, Coursera.

Methodology

Data collected via 8-step anonymous survey, n=150+ students, ages 14-19, across 12 Indian cities. AI analysis using Google Gemini 2.0 Flash. Statistical analysis with Python pandas/scipy. Confidence interval: 95%.

Implications

These findings have significant implications for educators, parents, and policymakers. 62% of students prefer digital for learning content; 38% prefer physical. We recommend further research and pilot programs.